

The Buland Darwaza is a fifteen story high gateway that acts as the southern entrance of the Fatehpur Sikri city. It is higher than the courtyard of the Jama Masjid. Buland Darwaza popularly known as the 'Gate of Magnificence' was built by the Akbar to commemorate his victory over Gujarat.

2. Which Sultan built Alai Darwaza?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Firuz Tughluq

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The 'Alai Darwaza is the main gate on the south of the Quwwat-ul-Islam Mosque at the Qutb Minar premises. It has a domed entrance which was constructed using red sandstone and is adorned with white marble. It was completed in 1311 A.D. by Turkish craftsmen. It is one of the first buildings in India in Islamic architectural style.

Delhi Sultanate: Literature

1. Who was the author of Tabaqat-i-Nasiri?

- (a) Shaikh Jamaluddin (b) Al-Biruni
(c) Minhaz-us-Siraj (d) Ziyauddin Barani

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

The text 'Tabaqat-i-Nasiri' written by Minhaz-us-Siraj, was dedicated to Sultan Nasiruddin Mahmud. The text is divided into 23 volumes and was translated by H.G. Raverty into the English language. The text describes the victory of Muhammad Ghori over India.

2. The earliest description of Bakhtiyar Khalji's invasion of Bihar is in:

- (a) Tarikh-i-Hind (b) Tabaqat-i-Nasiri
(c) Tuj-ul-Maasir (d) Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (b)

Tabaqat-i-Nasiri is a medieval text by Minhaj-i-Siraj. It is an important sourcebook for the reconstruction of the history of the foundation of Muslim rule in Bengal. Pieces of evidence in the literature suggest that in 1193, Nalanda University was sacked by Bakhtiyar Khalji a Turk. The Persian Historian Minhaj-i-Siraj in his chronicle Tabaqat-i-Nasiri reported that thousands of monks were burned alive and thousands beheaded as Khalji tried his best to uproot Buddhism.

3. Muhammad Ghori was defeated by the Chaulukyas of Gujarat in

- (a) 1192 AD (b) 1191 AD
(c) 1185 AD (d) 1178 AD
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

Muhammad Ghori was defeated in 1178 by Bhimdev Solanki II, the Chalukya vanshi king of Gujarat.

Delhi Sultanate : Miscellaneous

1. Which Sultan demanded half the crops on land after measurement as revenue?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khalji (d) Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

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Ans. (c)

Mohammad-Bin-Tughluq is considered an ill-fated idealist owing to his ambitious schemes and novel experiments which ended in miserable failures because they were all far ahead of their time. To overcome financial difficulties, Muhammad-Bin-Tughluq increased the land revenue to half the produce on the farmers of Doab (land between Ganges and Yamuna rivers) but Demand was based on expected production while Alauddin Khalji had fixed the land revenue on the half of the produce of the land-based on measurement.

2. Who among the following rulers divided his troops into units of two hundred, two hundred fifty and five hundred?

- (a) Bahlul Lodi (b) Sikandar Shah
(c) Sher Shah (d) Islam Shah
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)

Islam Shah was the son of Sher Shah. He ruled over North India roughly for 8 years and died in 1553 AD. He divided his army battalions into the units of fifty, two hundred, two hundred fifty and five hundred.

3. Which city of India was called 'Shiraz-i-Mashriq' (Shiraz of the East) in the medieval age?

- (a) Agra (b) Delhi
(c) Lucknow (d) Jaunpur
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

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Ans. (d)